**DIMITRIS ZOPOUNIDIS**

PhD Candidate | Business Analytics & Data-Driven Strategic Decision Intelligence (Data-to-Decision)
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https://dimitriszopounidisdslab.github.io/zopounidis-analytics/

## ACADEMIC PROFILE

Dimitris Zopounidis is a PhD Candidate at the **Data Science Laboratory - DS Lab** of the Technical University of Crete and a researcher specializing in Business Analytics, Artificial Intelligence (AI), Data Science, and Data-Driven Strategic Decision Intelligence. He is also affiliated with the Business Administration Sector of the Department of Economics at Aristotle University of Thessaloniki (AUTh) and the Fintech & Strategic Artificial Intelligence (FTSAI) Laboratory at the University of Macedonia.

His work focuses on the use of analytics and data-driven approaches to support strategic decision-making, governance, sustainability, and organizational transformation.

Combining academic research with real-world applications, he is actively involved in large-scale strategic projects across the banking, tourism, hospitality, and aviation sectors. He serves as Researcher on strategic initiatives developed in collaboration with **Alpha Bank**, including large-scale studies supporting strategic intelligence, economic development, data-driven decision-making, and evidence-based policymaking.

As Founder and Head of Research of the **Crete Aviation Observatory (CAO)**, one of Greece's leading independent aviation research initiatives, he leads empirical research on aviation analytics, sustainability, passenger behavior, and tourism-air transport dynamics. Through his academic, research, and industry engagements, he contributes to the transformation of data into actionable insights that support strategy development, organizational performance, and evidence-based decision-making.

His research interests include Business Analytics, Artificial Intelligence, Strategic Intelligence, AI governance, AI risk management, sustainability assessment, aviation analytics, banking research, financial analytics and data-driven decision-making.

## EDUCATION

**October 2025 - October 2028**

PhD Candidate, Data Science Laboratory - DS Lab
School of Production Engineering and Management
Technical University of Crete, Chania, Greece

**March 2024 - June 2025**

MSc in Business Analytics and Data Science
Department of Business Administration
University of Macedonia, Thessaloniki, Greece

**September 2019 - June 2023**

BSc in Business Administration
Department of Business Administration
University of Macedonia, Thessaloniki, Greece

## RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Technical University of Crete - Data Science Laboratory (DS Lab)**
*Researcher and PhD Candidate | Nov 2023 - Present*

**Alpha Bank**
*Researcher | May 2026 - Present*
Data-Driven Strategic Intelligence and Data-to-Decision Analytics Study
Large-scale strategic initiative supporting economic development, strategic intelligence, evidence-based decision-making, and policymaking for pathway to growth

*Artificial Intelligence Risk Management Researcher | Apr 2026 - Present*
Development of AI Risk Management Methodologies aligned with the EU AI Act and responsible AI governance practices.

**Crete Aviation Observatory (CAO)**
*Founder & Head of Research | Nov 2021 - Present*
Independent research initiative focused on aviation analytics, sustainability, and air transport development.

**Crete Tourism Observatory**
*Coordinator, Researcher & Data Analyst | Aug 2020 - Present*

Supporting tourism intelligence, data analysis, and evidence-based decision-making for tourism stakeholders.

**SeaCrete Hotels**
*Airport & Aviation Data Analyst* | *Aug 2025 - Present*

**Hania Hotels Association**
*Airport & Aviation Data Analyst* | *Sep 2025 - Present*

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

**Technical University of Crete**
Teaching Assistant, Master of Business Administration (MBA) Program | May 2026 - Present

**CIHEAM MAICh**
Teaching Assistant, Financial Management Laboratory | March 2025 - Present

## SCIENTIFIC COMMUNICATION & KNOWLEDGE DISSEMINATION

**aviationlife.gr**
Founder & Editor-in-Chief | Dec 2020 - Present

**Air Letter Magazine - Hellenic Aviation Society**
Editorial and Content Officer | Sep 2022 – Present

## PUBLICATIONS

**Sifakis, N., Zopounidis, D., Doumpos, M., & Zopounidis, K. (2026).** Stakeholder-anchored multi-criteria deployment of island hybrid renewable energy systems for lifecycle carbon reduction: A weight-robustness analysis. *Journal of Cleaner Production, 580*, 149690. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jclepro.2026.149690

**Research contribution:** Contributed to data curation, quantitative analysis, and visualization in a multi-criteria decision analysis (MCDA) framework integrating Random Forest, TreeSHAP, CRITIC, and TOPSIS to evaluate 14 hybrid renewable energy configurations for Crete. The study assesses decision robustness under alternative weighting schemes and identifies energy solutions with significant lifecycle carbon reduction potential.

## MEMBERSHIPS & RESEARCH NETWORKS

**EURO Working Group on Multiple Criteria Decision Aiding (EWG-MCDA)**
*Member* | *September 2026 - Present*

**Financial Engineering & Banking Society (FEBS)**
Member | *September 2020 - Present*

## EUROPEAN RESEARCH PROJECTS

**Sust-HEIn (University of Macedonia)**
Researcher / Data Analyst | *October 2024 – December 2024 & April 2025 – August 2025*

**AquaSphere (Technical University of Crete)**
Researcher / Data Analytics Lead | *April 2026 – Present*

## BOOKS

**Artificial Intelligence and Applications in Management**
Constantin Zopounidis, Dimitris Zopounidis, Angelos Kostis.
Barbounakis Publications, 2024.

## HONORS AND AWARDS

**2026 - Award of Excellence (3rd Place), SkyImpact Challenge**
*Heraklion International Airport, Crete*
Recognised among the **top three teams** in the SkyImpact Challenge for an innovative proposal supporting the future development of the New Heraklion International Airport.

## PRESENTATIONS AT CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS

**102nd Meeting of the EURO Working Group on Multiple Criteria Decision Aiding (EWG-MCDA)**
“Airport Sustainability Assessment: A PROMETHEE-Based Methodology and a Case Study for Greek

Airports”
Poster presentation | Zürich, Switzerland, 17–19 September 2026

**Joint Session: Technical University of Crete and the Royal Academy of Economic and Financial Sciences (RACEF)**

“AI Adoption by SMEs and Inclusive Regional Development in Island Economies: Drivers, Impacts, and Policy Implications”
Presentation | Chania, Crete, Greece, April, 23 2026

**15th National Conference of the Financial Engineering and Banking Society (FEBS)**

“Evaluating the ESG Efficiency of Global Airlines: A DEA-Based Approach”

National and Kapodistrian University of Athens (NKUA), Athens, Greece, December, 18 - 19 2025

**7th Hellenic Aviation Society Conference**

“An Empirical Analysis of the Relationship Between Corporate Financial Performance and ESG Factors in the Airline Sector”

Sofitel Athens Airport Hotel, Athens, Greece, June, 5 – 6 2025

**14th National Conference of the Financial Engineering and Banking Society (FEBS)**

“An Empirical Analysis of the Relationship Between Corporate Financial Performance and ESG Factors in the Airline Sector”

Athens University of Economics and Business, Athens, Greece, December, 19 - 20 2024

**12th National Conference of the Financial Engineering and Banking Society (FEBS)**

“Financial Cyber Risk Analysis: The Case of the Aviation Industry II”

University of West Attica, Athens, Greece, December, 19 - 20 2022

**11th National Conference of the Financial Engineering and Banking Society (FEBS)**

“Financial Cyber Risk Analysis: The Case of the Aviation Industry I”

American College of Greece, Athens, Greece, December, 20 - 21 2021

## PARTICIPATIONS

**8th Summer Conference on Financial Intermediation and Corporate Finance**
Participant | Athens, Greece, June 30, 2026

**LCA Training School - Multiple View Life Cycle Sustainability Assessment**
Participant | COST Action CA23157 - MultiViewLCSA
Thessaloniki, Greece | September, 6 - 11, 2026